FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Issue 007 Monday, November 9, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

Commercial & Facilities

Fire Protection · Paving · Facilities Services · Security Systems · Elevator · Venue & Catering

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

IN THIS ISSUE

FIRE PROTECTION
APi Group's Safety Services revenue rose 18.5% to $1,662 million in the third quarter, reported October 29, and the company raised its 2026 revenue outlook to $9.2-$9.25 billion.

PAVING
Georgia's asphalt cement index fell to $700 a ton for November and Louisiana's to $693, both below October and June but more than 22% above January.

FACILITIES SERVICES
Johnson Controls reported October 27 that fiscal fourth-quarter service revenue rose 8% organically to $2.1 billion, with Americas backlog up 54% to $17.8 billion on data center demand.

SECURITY SYSTEMS
ADT said on its November 3 call that it bought about 8,000 customer accounts in bulk for $9 million in cash, and that dealer and bulk-purchase volume was lower.

ELEVATOR
Otis reported October 28 that third-quarter modernization backlog rose 20% and modernization orders 10%, while new equipment orders rose only 1% at constant currency.

VENUE & CATERING
US Foods reported November 5 that independent restaurant case volume grew 5.0% in the third quarter while food cost inflation was 0.4%, and it narrowed its 2026 outlook.

BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

TRADE

Thrive Holdings agreed October 29 to buy ADT for $10.00 a share in cash, a $15.3 billion enterprise value, with a go-shop open to November 28.

Thrive Holdings, a permanent capital holding company, will pay $10.00 a share in cash for ADT, a 45.6% premium to the $6.87 close on October 27, ADT said October 29. The deal values ADT's equity at about $7.6 billion and the business at about $15.3 billion. ADT's board approved it unanimously. Financing commitments come solely from funds managed by affiliates of Apollo Global Management, and there is no financing condition.

ADT may solicit competing proposals for 30 days, until 11:59 p.m. New York time on November 28, with a possible 10-day extension for certain parties. ADT says it does not intend to disclose go-shop developments unless required. Closing needs ADT stockholder approval and U.S. antitrust approval and is expected in the first quarter of 2027. After closing, ADT will be privately held and its stock will stop trading on the NYSE.

ADT said its data and privacy policies will remain unchanged and no new data will be shared without customer permission. Thrive says ADT will form the foundation of its smart home security business. ADT's third-quarter release on November 3 showed revenue up 4% to $1,349 million, recurring monthly revenue of $360 million against $362 million a year earlier, and trailing gross revenue attrition of 13.1% against 13.0%. ADT withdrew its financial guidance.

On the November 3 call, ADT's chief executive said the deal recognizes the value built by 'our more than 12,000 employees and dealer partners.' Terms for dealers, bulk account purchases and monitoring contracts after closing have not been published.

What to do about it: If you sell or monitor ADT-branded accounts as a dealer, pull your dealer agreement this week and read the assignment, change-of-control and termination clauses; write down every notice period. Ask your ADT contact in writing whether dealer terms, bulk account purchase programs or monitoring rates will change, and keep the reply. If you compete with ADT for small-commercial accounts, update your own attrition and recurring-revenue figures now; ADT's are 13.1% and $360 million a month. If you own an alarm or monitoring book you might sell, get a written valuation before you take any offer. Check back November 28, when the go-shop ends.

ADT and Thrive merger release, Oct 29 (SEC Ex. 99.1) · ADT third-quarter 2026 earnings release, Nov 3 (SEC 8-K) · ADT Q3 earnings call transcript, Nov 3 (SEC DEFA14A)

FIRE PROTECTION

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

APi Group's Safety Services revenue rose 18.5% to $1,662 million in the third quarter, reported October 29, and the company raised its 2026 revenue outlook to $9.2-$9.25 billion.

Why it matters: Safety Services grew 8.8% organically; total revenue was $2,554 million, up 22.5%. APi's chief executive cited 'strong demand across our inspection, service, and monitoring business' and a growing backlog. APi raised its adjusted EBITDA outlook to $1,235-$1,255 million from $1,205-$1,245 million. If you compete with APi for inspection routes or technicians, compare your inspection pricing and technician pay with current offers this week.

APi Group Q3 2026 earnings release, Oct 29 (SEC Ex. 99.1) · APi Group Q3 2026 results release (investor site PDF)

DEMAND

NFSA's November 6 policy post calls high-rise retrofit 'perhaps one of the clearest examples' of the fire-safety field moving from one crisis to the next, and says thousands of existing high-rises still lack complete automatic sprinkler protection.

Why it matters: The post cites a National High-Rise Retrofit Summit remark that 'The Buildings Are Still There'. It names lithium-ion batteries, wildland-urban interface fires and open parking garages as newer hazards drawing attention away from older ones. If you design, install or inspect sprinklers in high-rises, ask each building owner in writing whether the building is fully sprinklered, and keep the answers on file for your next proposal.

NFSA: Shiny: The Next Disaster, Nov 6

PAVING

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

Georgia's asphalt cement index fell to $700 a ton for November and Louisiana's to $693, both below October and June but more than 22% above January.

Why it matters: Georgia posted $700 for November against $704 in October, a $721 June peak and $566 in January, which is 23.7% above January. Louisiana's November 1 reading was $693 against $706 on October 1, $717 in June and $566 in January, 22.4% above January. If you carry price-adjustment clauses on state paving work, confirm which index and which month each clause uses before you quote spring jobs.

Georgia DOT Asphalt Cement Price Index, 2026 · Louisiana DOTD monthly price indices, asphalt cement

SUPPLY

Colorado's asphalt cement index has fallen four months running to $579.20 for October, while Indiana's binder index stood at $568 in September, down from $627 in June.

Why it matters: Colorado's latest posting is October at $579.20, below $584.93 in June and $581.07 in September, and still 16.9% above January's $495.32. Indiana's latest posting is September at $568, 9.4% below June and 21.6% above January's $467; October and November are not yet posted. If you bid in either state, get a current delivered quote from your supplier and compare it with the posted index before you price.

Colorado DOT asphalt cement cost adjustment index · Indiana DOT PG asphalt binder index

FACILITIES SERVICES

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Johnson Controls reported October 27 that fiscal fourth-quarter service revenue rose 8% organically to $2.1 billion, with Americas backlog up 54% to $17.8 billion on data center demand.

Why it matters: Total backlog was $23.0 billion, up 43% organically, and organic orders rose 44%. Johnson Controls guided fiscal 2027 organic sales growth of 11% to 12%, and its Americas adjusted segment EBITA margin was 22.0%. If you subcontract controls, mechanical or building-automation work, ask your vendors for current lead times and technician availability in writing before you commit to fixed-price service agreements.

Johnson Controls Q4 and FY26 results release, Oct 27

LABOR

CleanLink reported September 2 that 89% of janitorial firms have 20 or fewer employees, while 294 firms with 500 or more staff employ 43.1% of the industry's workers.

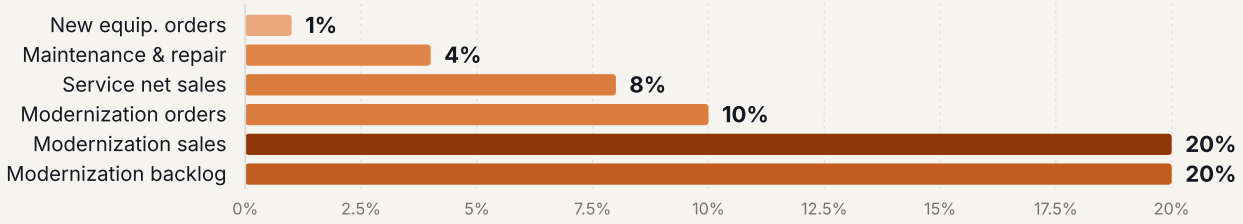
Why it matters: The firm counts are for 2022: 62,970 firms and 67,295 establishments, with industry revenue of $72.8 billion against $44.2 billion in 2015. BLS put the 2024 median janitor wage at $17.27 an hour, and 44% of CleanLink-polled members say pay competition adds to staffing challenges. A BSCAI and Contracting Profits study found 2025 sales and profits slightly above 2024, with respondents expecting 2026 to stay flat. Compare your hourly rates with $17.27 and write down your pay ranges before January bids.

CleanLink: Commercial Cleaning by Numbers, Sep 2

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / OTIS Q3 GROWTH

Otis's modernization backlog and organic modernization sales each grew 20% in the third quarter, against 1% for new equipment orders.

Otis Q3 2026, % growth year over year; orders and backlog at constant currency, maintenance and modernization sales organic, service net sales as reported; release dated October 28, 2026



Modernization of equipment already installed is where Otis reports its fastest growth: backlog and organic sales both up 20%, orders up 10%. New equipment orders grew 1%, and maintenance and repair 4%. Service net sales were $2,616 million at a 24.2% margin. If you maintain elevators, check which of your accounts have equipment due for upgrades. Otis Q3 2026 results release, Oct 28 (SEC Ex. 99.1)

SECURITY SYSTEMS

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

ADT said on its November 3 call that it bought about 8,000 customer accounts in bulk for $9 million in cash, and that dealer and bulk-purchase volume was lower.

Why it matters: At those figures ADT paid about $1,125 an account. The call transcript says direct professional installs were offset by 'lower volume from dealers and bulk account purchases,' and the release shows dealer-generated account and bulk purchase outflows of $124 million against $157 million a year earlier. ADT's chief executive credited 'dealer partners' when discussing the Thrive deal on the November 3 call. If you might sell accounts, get a written valuation of your monitoring base and compare it with $1,125 an account; one bulk purchase is not a market price.

ADT Q3 earnings call transcript, Nov 3 (SEC DEFA14A) · ADT third-quarter 2026 earnings release, Nov 3 (SEC 8-K)

DEMAND

ADT's third-quarter revenue rose 4% to $1,349 million, but monitoring revenue slipped to $1,084 million from $1,098 million while installation and product revenue rose to $265 million from $200 million.

Why it matters: Reported November 3. Installation, product and other revenue rose 32.5% and monitoring and related services fell 1.3%, partly from the October 2025 multifamily sale. Recurring monthly revenue was $360 million against $362 million, and adjusted EBITDA margin was 49% against 52%. ADT withdrew its financial guidance. Pull your own recurring monthly revenue and attrition for the last four quarters this week, the two figures ADT highlights for its monitoring base.

ADT third-quarter 2026 earnings release, Nov 3 (SEC 8-K)

ELEVATOR

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Otis reported October 28 that third-quarter modernization backlog rose 20% and modernization orders 10%, while new equipment orders rose only 1% at constant currency.

Why it matters: Organic modernization sales rose 20% and organic maintenance and repair sales 4%. Service net sales were $2,616 million, up 8%, at a 24.2% segment margin. New equipment orders grew in the low teens in the Americas and fell by a low-teens percentage in China. Otis kept its 2026 outlook. If you maintain elevators, list which of your accounts have equipment due for modernization and put those quotes in writing this quarter.

Otis Q3 2026 results release, Oct 28 (SEC Ex. 99.1) · Otis reports third quarter 2026 results (Finviz copy)

REGULATION

Pennsylvania's elevator Regulation #12-123 takes effect December 20, 2026, with state information meetings in Harrisburg November 10, Pittsburgh November 12 and online November 16.

Why it matters: The state's elevator page says the Department is preparing guidance before the effective date. An Elevator Blueprint summary says the rules adopt ASME A17.1-2016 with Pennsylvania modifications, make Category 1 testing a stand-alone annual requirement, and set December 20, 2027 for each covered unit's first annual test. Periodic inspections stay at six or twelve months. If you own or service Pennsylvania elevators, attend a meeting and ask whether your maintenance contracts include Category 1 tests.

Pennsylvania L&I elevator regulations page · Elevator Blueprint: Pennsylvania annual test

VENUE & CATERING

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

US Foods reported November 5 that independent restaurant case volume grew 5.0% in the third quarter while food cost inflation was 0.4%, and it narrowed its 2026 outlook.

Why it matters: Total case volume rose 1.3% and net sales rose 2.1% to $10.4 billion. US Foods cut the top of its 2026 ranges: net sales growth to 4%-5% from 4%-6%, adjusted EBITDA growth to 9%-11% from 9%-13%, and adjusted EPS growth to 18%-20% from 18%-24%. Its CFO said it tightened the outlook 'to reflect the reality of a sustained slower macroeconomic environment.' If you cater or run a venue kitchen, ask your broadline rep what price protection applies to your top 20 items and get it in writing before holiday quoting.

US Foods Q3 fiscal 2026 earnings release, Nov 5 (SEC)

MONEY

Sysco reported November 3 that product cost inflation was 0.3% in its fiscal first quarter, mostly in meat, and that full-year sales growth will land at the low end of 6% to 7%.

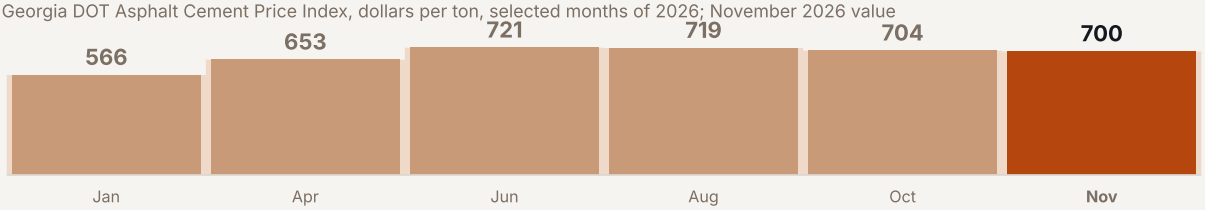
Why it matters: Sysco's sales rose 2.8% to $21.7 billion and local case volume in U.S. Foodservice rose 2.7% for the 13 weeks ended September 26. Adjusted operating income was $927 million, up 3.2%. Sysco reiterated fiscal 2027 adjusted EPS growth of 9% to 11% and attributed the lower sales outlook to a lower inflation environment. If your event menus lean on beef or other meat, recost them against your last quote and update per-head pricing before you sign December and January events.

Sysco Q1 fiscal 2027 results, Nov 3 (Finviz copy)

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / GEORGIA ASPHALT

Georgia's asphalt cement index peaked at $721 a ton in June and has slipped to $700 in November, still $134 above January.

Georgia DOT Asphalt Cement Price Index, dollars per ton, selected months of 2026; November 2026 value

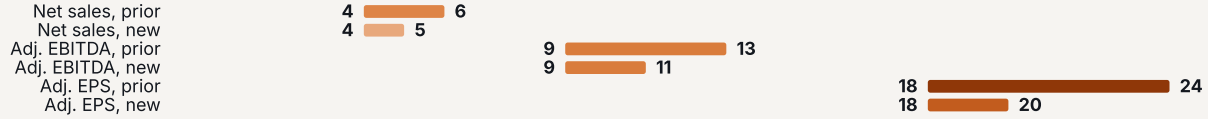


The index rose $87 a ton from January to April and $68 more by June, then eased $21 to $700 in November. That is 23.7% above January. Louisiana's November 1 reading was $693, down $13 from October. If you price state work against an index, confirm which month your clause uses. Georgia DOT Asphalt Cement Price Index, 2026

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / US FOODS OUTLOOK

US Foods trimmed the top of each 2026 growth range on November 5 and left the bottom of each where it was.

US Foods fiscal 2026 guidance, % growth, prior range against range issued with Q3 results on November 5, 2026



Each pair shows the old range above the new one. Top ends fell by 1, 2 and 4 points; bottoms held. Independent restaurant case growth was 5.0% against 1.3% for all cases, and food cost inflation 0.4%. The guidance includes a 53rd week worth roughly 1% of case and EBITDA growth. US Foods Q3 fiscal 2026 earnings release, Nov 5 (SEC)

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

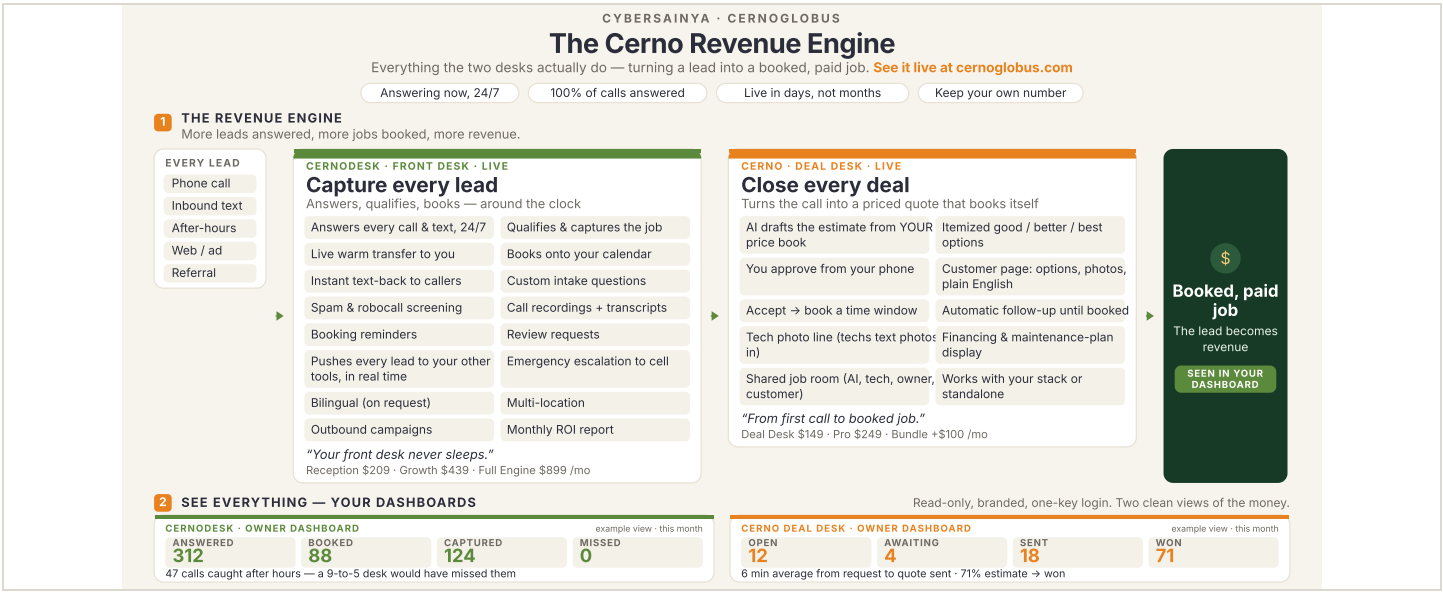
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a commercial contractor. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails proposals, work orders and vendor invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



FREE FROM CERNOGLOBUS

Wary of AI? Start where it falls over.

Module 1 of **AI for Business Growth** is free to read — no signup, no card.

What AI is good for in a trade business, and where it breaks. Seven modules, $149. · cernoglobus.com/ai-for-business-growth

Questions? Reach out.
Corrections, tips, or something you want covered next.
info@cernoglobus.com

The Revenue Engine
See both desks running, and the pricing

AI for Business Growth
Module 1 free — no signup, no card

Subscribe
Get this brief every other Monday

CernoGlobus
Who publishes this brief, and what we build